



Yanrui Jiang

Researcher — Industrial Location, Logistics Real Estate & Spatial Analysis

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01 PROFILE

Researcher with a Master of Architecture and postgraduate training in urban studies (expected graduation October 2026). Research sits at two ends of one question — how capital, land and infrastructure decide where things get built: a master's thesis on how Chinese cross-border e-commerce capital physically landed in the Wallonia-Liège logistics node, and field-verified spatial data on urban human-animal relations in Brussels. Both combine documentary and market evidence — company information, planning documents, cadastral and land-registry records — with GIS, mapping and descriptive quantification. Writes research reports and presents findings in English and Chinese. Uses generative AI inside a documented verification protocol: sources returned for manual cross-checking, analytical frameworks and coding rules self-designed, hallucinated output excluded. Seeking an entry-level research or analyst role applying location, market and spatial analysis.

02 EDUCATION

Joint Master of Science in Urban Studies

2024 – 2026

Vrije Universiteit Brussel (VUB) & Université libre de Bruxelles (ULB), Belgium

MSc Urban Studies (VUB) and MSc Geography, track Urban Studies (ULB). Expected graduation: October 2026. Degree authentication (CSCSE, China): expected December 2026.

Master of Architecture

2020 – 2023

Tongji University, China

College of Architecture and Planning; field: Architectural History & Theory. Outstanding Master's Thesis Award, 2024.

Bachelor of Environmental Art Design

2015 – 2019

Shanghai Normal University, China

03 RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern — Mapping Pigeon Feeding Hotspots, Brussels

Mar – Jun 2026

Université de Namur, Belgium — B-POHOW research project

- Built a field-verified spatial database of pigeon feeding hotspots across the Brussels-Capital Region, for a research project framed by One Health and One Welfare.
- Screened **more than 175 candidate locations** through bicycle-based fieldwork on a standardised observation protocol, confirming **115 active feeding hotspots** and collecting **1,503 photographs and videos (17 GB)**.
- Cleaned and coded records from municipal and field-partner sources in French and Dutch into **seven feeding-type categories**, resolving hybrid cases with the supervisor.
- Produced the project's GIS outputs — hotspot distribution, kernel-density heatmaps, flock-size maps and exploratory socio-economic overlays — and quantified findings such as **45.2%** of active hotspots being unauthorised intentional feeding.
- Took part in two stakeholder meetings with Brussels municipalities and contributed to an academic Fact Sheet for the journal *Brussels Studies*, with sensitive locations anonymised.

Master's Thesis — The “Landing” of Transnational E-commerce Capital (Liège)

2024 – 2026

Vrije Universiteit Brussel (MSc Urban Studies) & Université libre de Bruxelles (MSc Geography)

- Examined how Chinese cross-border e-commerce capital physically materialised in the Wallonia-Liège logistics node, at three scales: macro institutional matching, meso logistics-led urbanisation, and micro spatial friction.
- Coded policy, planning, cadastral, market, corporate and municipal documents into a structured coding table used as the analytical infrastructure of the thesis.
- Combined qualitative document analysis with descriptive quantification, process tracing and spatial reconstruction — including an institutional timeline spanning **1990–2025** and firm-clustering analysis verified against satellite imagery and orthophotos.
- Used generative AI only for corpus extraction with mandatory source-sentence return, terminology translation, diagram-style testing and proofreading; primary data was collected manually and every AI output verified, with hallucinated content excluded.

Master's Thesis — Mixed Development Space of “Owner-occupied and Rented”

2020 – 2023

College of Architecture and Planning, Tongji University

- Reconstituted the composition and evolution of private mixed development space in modern Shanghai, combining morpho-typological reading with historical land-registry evidence and urban social geography.
- Reconstructed **eight cases across eight districts**, from the old county town and the traditional city ward to the central, northern, eastern and western concession districts.
- Awarded Tongji University's **Outstanding Master's Thesis Award**, 2024.

04 PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Architect — Public-Service Planning Programme, New Jiangwan City

Mar 2023 – Mar 2024

Shanghai Urban Regeneration Co., Ltd.

- Assessed the provision of elderly-care and healthcare facilities against resident needs under Shanghai's **15-minute neighbourhood** framework.
- Built a facility inventory from census data, official registers and field checks; reconciled conflicting sources and benchmarked counts, floor areas and service radii against municipal standards to locate underserved areas.
- Analysed resident survey responses, separating basic provision from service improvements and prioritising needs across short-, medium- and long-term interventions; used AI to assist with coding open-ended responses, with categories reviewed manually.
- Prepared an action plan covering **nine regeneration projects** — site-level parameters and implementation phasing — submitted to the subdistrict government and planning authorities.

05 PUBLICATIONS

- **Liège Airport: A Chinese E-commerce Gateway in the Benelux.** *BeNeLux Geography Conference, 2026* — parallel-session presentation. **FIRST AUTHOR**
- **Property Rights, Capital and Urban Form: Spatial Transformation in Modern Shanghai's Hongkou.** *Time + Architecture*, 2026.
- **Modernism Across Cultures: Kunio Maekawa's Apartment Villa in Shanghai, 1939–1941.** *Time + Architecture*, 2024.
- **Beyond the West Gate: Street-Lane Structures in Modern Shanghai's Urban Morphology.** *Time + Architecture*, 2023.
- **Neighbourhood Regeneration: A Former Barracks Site in Central Paris.** *Shanghai Urban Planning*, 2023.

The Liège Airport conference paper is first-authored. The four journal articles (2023–2026) are co-authored contributions on modern Shanghai urban morphology, regeneration and property rights, written with Tongji University's College of Architecture and Urban Planning.

06 SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Research & analysis — sector and market scanning, company and competitor information, location benchmarking, supply-demand and gap analysis, indicator definition and source reconciliation; field survey design and standardised observation protocols.

Data & spatial analysis — multi-source collection, cleaning, structuring and documentation; Excel; Python for data preparation and analysis; ArcGIS / QGIS (kernel density, overlay, buffer, service-radius and thematic mapping).

AI-assisted research — generative AI used only inside a documented verification protocol — corpus extraction with mandatory return of source sentences for manual cross-checking, Chinese–English terminology translation, diagram-style testing from hand-made drafts, and proofreading. Primary data collected manually; frameworks and coding rules self-designed; hallucinated output excluded after review. Also used to assist coding of open-ended survey responses, with categories reviewed manually.

Other tools — Microsoft Office; AutoCAD, SketchUp, Photoshop, Illustrator.

Languages — Mandarin (native); English (professional working proficiency — research writing and presentation).